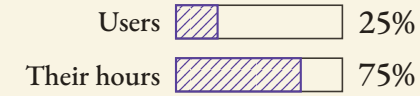
Spotify's audiobooks: little data to learn from

When Spotify launched audiobooks it had little data to learn from.

Each audiobook had to be bought before it could be streamed, and about a quarter of the users made three quarters of the listening hours.

But over 70% of the first audiobook listeners already listened to podcasts.

Audiobook listening hours at launch

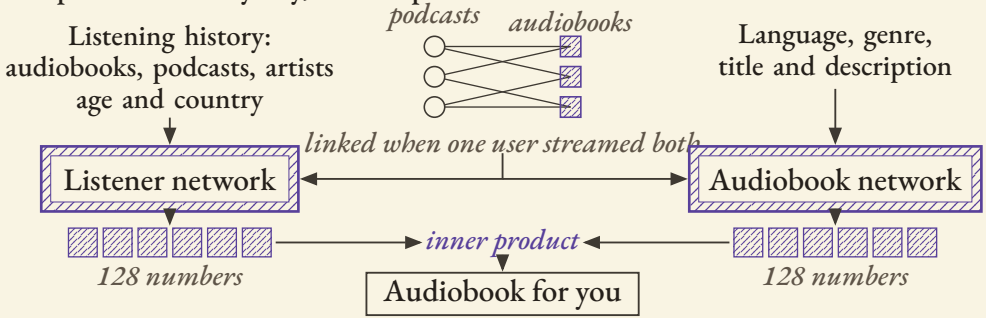


First audiobook listeners who already listened to podcasts

De Nadai and others (Spotify), Companion Proceedings of the Web Conference (WWW) 2024.

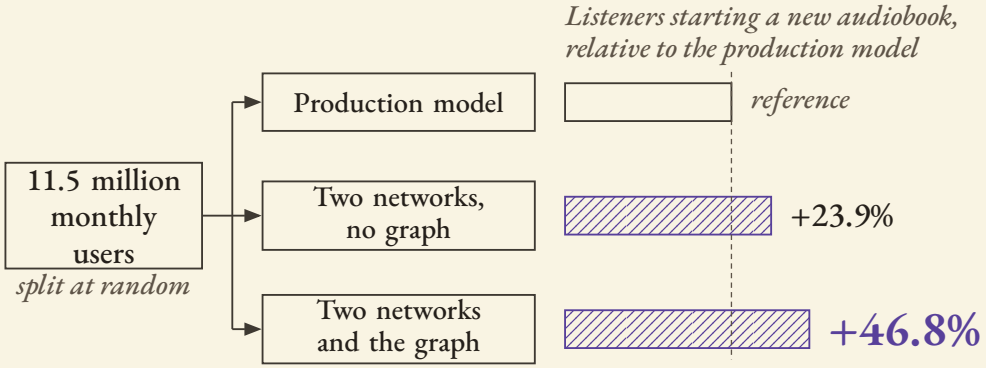
128 numbers for every listener and every audiobook

In the matchmaker the numbers were learned directly. Here two networks compute them every day, from inputs on both sides.



De Nadai and others (Spotify), Companion Proceedings of the Web Conference (WWW) 2024.

The A/B test: 11.5 million users in three groups



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